

# WOODLAND FLUFFY SKIRT

## LME BABY COLLECTION - WOODLAND DREAMS

A light, airy crocheted skirt with three soft, cascading ruffle tiers and an elegant fall, just like cotton candy. Crocheted top-down: an elastic waistband, a light A-line body and three fluffy ruffle tiers with a pretty finishing edge at the hem. Sixteen sizes, from preemie to 14-16 years, made to fit perfectly together with the Woodland Dreams Basisbody.

**By Renate Dahl**

Little Montessori Explorers

[lmexplorers.com](http://lmexplorers.com)



*TIP: Read through the whole pattern and the size chart on page 4 before you start, and crochet a 10 x 10 cm gauge swatch in double crochet to check your tension.*

## ABOUT THE WOODLAND FLUFFY SKIRT

### PART OF THE COLLECTION

The Woodland Fluffy Skirt is the crocheted piece in LME Woodland Dreams, made to fit perfectly together with the knitted Basisbody. The skirt is not a copy of any existing design, it's drafted and graded from scratch, inspired by a light, fluffy ruffle skirt.

### STYLE

Scandinavian, timeless and exclusive, with a light and airy feel. Soft ruffles, an elegant fall, and a calm, minimalist shape, with no heavy or dense stitches weighing the skirt down.

### FIT

**An elastic waistband makes the skirt comfortable and easy to put on, while the light A-line shape gives freedom of movement. Each of the three ruffle tiers is crocheted airily with multiplied stitches, not dense and heavy, so the cascading fall stays light even in the largest sizes.**

## MATERIALS

### YARN

Sandnes Garn Alpakka (100% alpaca), or an equivalent yarn with the same gauge. The skirt can be crocheted in one of the collection's calm natural colours (cream, linen, sand, oatmeal, beige) for a quiet look, or in one of the accessory colours (sage green, dusty rose, butter yellow, soft blue, olive, terracotta) for a more colourful look together with the Basisbody.

### YARN REQUIREMENTS

| Size     | Yarn amount |
|----------|-------------|
| Prematur | 70-80 g     |
| Nyfødt   | 80-90 g     |
| 0-3 mnd  | 90-100 g    |
| 3-6 mnd  | 100-115 g   |
| 6-9 mnd  | 115-130 g   |
| 9-12 mnd | 130-145 g   |
| 1-2 år   | 150-165 g   |
| 2-3 år   | 170-190 g   |
| 3-4 år   | 195-215 g   |
| 4-5 år   | 215-235 g   |
| 5-6 år   | 235-260 g   |
| 6-8 år   | 260-285 g   |
| 8-10 år  | 285-310 g   |
| 10-12 år | 310-340 g   |
| 12-14 år | 340-370 g   |
| 14-16 år | 370-400 g   |

### EQUIPMENT

4 mm crochet hook. Soft, flat elastic 1-1.5 cm wide, cut to waist measurement minus 2 cm (see the size chart). A <sup>3</sup>tapestry needle and a safety pin or a small crochet hook to thread the elastic through the waistband channel.

## SIZE CHART

Finished measurements. Choose size by waist measurement, or test the waistband around the child's waist before crocheting on.

| Size     | Waist (child's) | Skirt length | Elastic length |
|----------|-----------------|--------------|----------------|
| Prematur | 32 cm           | 13 cm        | 30 cm          |
| Nyfødt   | 34 cm           | 14 cm        | 32 cm          |
| 0-3 mnd  | 36 cm           | 15 cm        | 34 cm          |
| 3-6 mnd  | 38 cm           | 16 cm        | 36 cm          |
| 6-9 mnd  | 40 cm           | 17 cm        | 38 cm          |
| 9-12 mnd | 42 cm           | 18 cm        | 40 cm          |
| 1-2 år   | 46 cm           | 20 cm        | 44 cm          |
| 2-3 år   | 49 cm           | 22 cm        | 47 cm          |
| 3-4 år   | 52 cm           | 24 cm        | 50 cm          |
| 4-5 år   | 54 cm           | 26 cm        | 52 cm          |
| 5-6 år   | 56 cm           | 28 cm        | 54 cm          |
| 6-8 år   | 58 cm           | 30 cm        | 56 cm          |
| 8-10 år  | 61 cm           | 32 cm        | 59 cm          |
| 10-12 år | 64 cm           | 34 cm        | 62 cm          |
| 12-14 år | 67 cm           | 36 cm        | 65 cm          |
| 14-16 år | 70 cm           | 38 cm        | 68 cm          |

**Waist measurement is the child's actual measurement. The waistband itself is crocheted a little smaller than this (see part 1), since the elastic stretches it out to a good, snug fit.**

## GAUGE AND DIFFICULTY LEVEL

### GAUGE

20 double crochets and 30 rounds = 10 x 15 cm, on a 4 mm hook. This gauge is used in every calculation in the pattern. Always crochet a swatch first: chain a foundation row, work double crochet for approx. 12 cm wide and 15 cm tall, block lightly. If your gauge does not match, change to a smaller or larger hook until it does.

### DIFFICULTY LEVEL

**Medium.** You should be comfortable crocheting in the round, increasing evenly spaced, and working double crochets and multiplied stitches. No complicated stitch repeats, the whole skirt is worked in plain rounds of double crochet.

## ABBREVIATIONS

Norwegian crochet terms with US crochet terms alongside.

| Norwegian   | US         | Meaning                                   |
|-------------|------------|-------------------------------------------|
| lm          | ch         | luftmaske                                 |
| fm          | sc         | fastmaske                                 |
| stav        | dc         | stav (double crochet)                     |
| halvstav    | hdc        | halv stav (half double crochet)           |
| m           | st(s)      | maske(r)                                  |
| omg         | rnd        | omgang                                    |
| øk          | inc        | øk (hekle 2 m i samme maske)              |
| felle       | dec        | felle (hekle 2 m sammen til 1)            |
| kjedemaske  | sl st      | kjedemaske / slip stitch                  |
| picot       | picot      | 3 lm, kjedemaske i 1. lm, en liten "tagg" |
| magisk ring | magic ring | justerbar starttring                      |

### TIPS

- Place a stitch marker at the start of every round, it is easy to lose count in a long piece worked in the round.
- Always crochet a swatch, even in double crochet, alpaca behaves a little differently from cotton or wool.
- Count your stitches at every checkpoint in the tables, it is easier to fix 4 rounds back than 40.

## HOW THE SKIRT IS CONSTRUCTED

The skirt is crocheted top-down, in one piece, in four simple parts:

### 1. The waistband

A firm, narrow sc channel for the elastic, crocheted a little smaller than the waist measurement.

### 2. The A-line body

Double crochets in plain rounds, with spread-out increase rounds that give the skirt its light A-line shape.

### 3. The three ruffle tiers

The stitches are multiplied over three separate rounds, one cascading tier at a time, for an airy, fluffy fall.

### 4. The edge

Finished with a small picot edge at the bottom of the last ruffle tier.

## PART 1: THE WAISTBAND

The skirt starts at the top, at the waistband. Crochet a foundation chain and join it into a ring with a slip stitch, or start with a magic ring, whichever you prefer.

Work 4 rounds of single crochet around, with no increasing. This gives a firm, tight channel that the elastic will later be threaded through.

| Size     | Foundation (sc around) | Rounds in waistband | Elastic length |
|----------|------------------------|---------------------|----------------|
| Prematur | 56                     | 4                   | 30 cm          |
| Nyfødt   | 60                     | 4                   | 32 cm          |
| 0-3 mnd  | 64                     | 4                   | 34 cm          |
| 3-6 mnd  | 68                     | 4                   | 36 cm          |
| 6-9 mnd  | 72                     | 4                   | 38 cm          |
| 9-12 mnd | 76                     | 4                   | 40 cm          |
| 1-2 år   | 84                     | 4                   | 44 cm          |
| 2-3 år   | 88                     | 4                   | 47 cm          |
| 3-4 år   | 96                     | 4                   | 50 cm          |
| 4-5 år   | 100                    | 4                   | 52 cm          |
| 5-6 år   | 104                    | 4                   | 54 cm          |
| 6-8 år   | 108                    | 4                   | 56 cm          |
| 8-10 år  | 112                    | 4                   | 59 cm          |
| 10-12 år | 116                    | 4                   | 62 cm          |
| 12-14 år | 120                    | 4                   | 65 cm          |
| 14-16 år | 128                    | 4                   | 68 cm          |

**Check:** lay the waistband flat, count the stitches around. They should match the number in the "Foundation" column for your size, before you move on to part 2.



## PART 2: THE A-LINE BODY

Switch to double crochet. Now the body of the skirt is worked, with evenly spread increase rounds that give it the light A-line shape. The construction is the same for every size, only the numbers change, see the grading table below.

**Example with numbers for preemie:** Spread 7 increase rounds evenly across the 12 rounds in this part (roughly every 2 rounds, adjust slightly so the last increase round falls near the end of the section). On an increase round: work 2 double crochets in every fourth stitch around (4 increase points evenly spaced), plain double crochet in the remaining stitches. Outside the increase rounds, crochet plain, with no increasing.

| Size     | Start (from waistband) | Increase rounds | Rounds in this part | End (to ruffle) |
|----------|------------------------|-----------------|---------------------|-----------------|
| Prematur | 56                     | 7               | 12                  | 84              |
| Nyfødt   | 60                     | 8               | 13                  | 92              |
| 0-3 mnd  | 64                     | 8               | 14                  | 96              |
| 3-6 mnd  | 68                     | 9               | 15                  | 104             |
| 6-9 mnd  | 72                     | 10              | 16                  | 112             |
| 9-12 mnd | 76                     | 10              | 18                  | 116             |
| 1-2 år   | 84                     | 11              | 20                  | 128             |
| 2-3 år   | 88                     | 12              | 22                  | 136             |
| 3-4 år   | 96                     | 13              | 24                  | 148             |
| 4-5 år   | 100                    | 13              | 26                  | 152             |
| 5-6 år   | 104                    | 14              | 29                  | 160             |
| 6-8 år   | 108                    | 14              | 31                  | 164             |
| 8-10 år  | 112                    | 15              | 33                  | 172             |
| 10-12 år | 116                    | 16              | 35                  | 180             |
| 12-14 år | 120                    | 16              | 37                  | 184             |
| 14-16 år | 128                    | 17              | 40                  | 196             |

**Check: count your stitches. They should match the number in the "End" column for your size, before you move on to part 3.**

## PART 3: THE THREE RUFFLE TIERS

This is where the fluffy magic happens: instead of one big ruffle, three separate, cascading tiers are crocheted one after another, just like real cotton candy. Each tier starts with a multiplying round, giving an airy, wavy fall, followed by a few plain rounds of double crochet on the new, larger stitch count, before the next tier starts with a new multiplying round.

**Example with numbers for preemie:** Multiplying round: work approximately 1.33 double crochets in each stitch around (adjust by 1 up or down per stitch so the final count matches the table exactly), until you have 112 stitches. Then work 2 plain rounds of double crochet, with no increasing, on the new stitch count. That is one ruffle tier done. Repeat this same recipe (3 multiplying rounds with plain double crochet in between) for the remaining tiers, using the numbers from the table below for your size, before the finishing edge on the next page.

| Size     | Start (from body) | Ruffle tier 1    | Ruffle tier 2     | Ruffle tier 3 (hem) |
|----------|-------------------|------------------|-------------------|---------------------|
| Preemie  | 84                | 112 sts (2 rnds) | 152 sts (2 rnds)  | 216 sts (3 rnds)    |
| Newborn  | 92                | 124 sts (2 rnds) | 168 sts (3 rnds)  | 236 sts (3 rnds)    |
| 0-3 mo   | 96                | 132 sts (3 rnds) | 180 sts (3 rnds)  | 248 sts (3 rnds)    |
| 3-6 mo   | 104               | 140 sts (3 rnds) | 192 sts (3 rnds)  | 268 sts (4 rnds)    |
| 6-9 mo   | 112               | 152 sts (3 rnds) | 208 sts (4 rnds)  | 288 sts (4 rnds)    |
| 9-12 mo  | 116               | 156 sts (3 rnds) | 212 sts (4 rnds)  | 300 sts (4 rnds)    |
| 1-2 yr   | 128               | 176 sts (4 rnds) | 240 sts (4 rnds)  | 332 sts (5 rnds)    |
| 2-3 yr   | 136               | 184 sts (5 rnds) | 252 sts (5 rnds)  | 352 sts (5 rnds)    |
| 3-4 yr   | 148               | 200 sts (5 rnds) | 272 sts (6 rnds)  | 384 sts (6 rnds)    |
| 4-5 yr   | 152               | 208 sts (6 rnds) | 284 sts (6 rnds)  | 392 sts (7 rnds)    |
| 5-6 yr   | 160               | 220 sts (6 rnds) | 300 sts (7 rnds)  | 416 sts (7 rnds)    |
| 6-8 yr   | 164               | 224 sts (7 rnds) | 304 sts (7 rnds)  | 424 sts (8 rnds)    |
| 8-10 yr  | 172               | 236 sts (8 rnds) | 324 sts (8 rnds)  | 444 sts (8 rnds)    |
| 10-12 yr | 180               | 248 sts (8 rnds) | 340 sts (9 rnds)  | 468 sts (9 rnds)    |
| 12-14 yr | 184               | 252 sts (9 rnds) | 344 sts (9 rnds)  | 476 sts (10 rnds)   |
| 14-16 yr | 196               | 268 sts (9 rnds) | 368 sts (10 rnds) | 508 sts (10 rnds)   |

## THE FINISHING EDGE

A small decorative edge finishes the ruffle and keeps the edge from curling.

Work 1 round of single crochet around, evenly spaced (no increasing or decreasing this round). Then work the picot edge: \*1 sc in each of the next 2 stitches, picot (ch 3, slip stitch in the first of the 3 chains)\*, repeat from \* to \* around. Fasten off and weave in the end.

## FINISHING

- 1 Cut the elastic to the length given for your size in the size chart (waist measurement minus 2 cm).
- 2 Attach a safety pin or a small crochet hook to one end of the elastic, and thread it through the waistband channel all the way around.
- 3 Overlap the two ends of the elastic by 1-2 cm, and sew them securely together with a tapestry needle and thread, back and forth several times.
- 4 Let the waistband slide back so the elastic join is hidden inside the channel.
- 5 Weave in all loose ends securely on the wrong side, and trim them short.
- 6 Lightly steam-block the skirt, avoid pressing directly on the ruffle, it should keep its airiness.

## SAFETY AND CARE

### SAFETY

- Use soft, flat elastic with no sharp edges, and check the join regularly, especially after washing.
- This pattern is not intended for children who put small objects in their mouth unsupervised.
- All measurements and stitch counts are calculated for a roomy, comfortable fit, always follow current safety recommendations for children's clothing.

### CARE INSTRUCTIONS

**Hand wash gently in lukewarm water with wool wash, or machine wash on a wool cycle at 30 degrees. Press out the water, gently ease the ruffle into shape, and dry lying flat on a towel.**

## ALL DONE!

**Congratulations, your Woodland Fluffy Skirt is finished! Combine it with the Basisbody and one of the accessory patterns for a complete, coordinated Woodland Dreams outfit.**

### THE REST OF THE COLLECTION

- Woodland Dreams Basisbody, the knitted foundation of the collection.
- Lace collar, a loose collar that fastens at the back.
- Ruffle collar, the same fastening, a little more romantic.
- Peter Pan collar, a classic rounded collar.
- Bib, tied with an i-cord or a button.
- I-cord suspenders, the collection's signature piece, adjustable and crossing at the back.
- Short vest, with wooden buttons at the front, worn over the body.

### COPYRIGHT

(c) Renate Dahl, Little Montessori Explorers. This pattern is a fully original LME design. You are welcome to sell finished garments you make from this pattern, on a small personal scale, provided the finished product is checked against current safety requirements. The pattern itself, its text and images, may not be shared, copied or resold.

By Renate Dahl · Little Montessori Explorers · [lmexplorers.com](https://lmexplorers.com)